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Sometime in between, possibly in early 1907, K. Chidambaranatha Mudaliar, landlord from Shiyali (Sirkazhi) was inducted as director.[40]

By mid-November the composition of SSNCo and its objectives had widened further.[41] Twenty additional directors were to be inducted to the board in its first ordinary meeting. P.L. Vengu Aiyar, a district court vakil of Tuticorin joined as a fifth legal adviser. The National Bank of India was dropped as it was not—despite its name—a Swadeshi bank. The new bankers were the Tirunelveli South India Bank Ltd; Messrs V.E.N.K.R.MA., Tuticorin; Messrs A.L.A.R., Tuticorin; Messrs A.R.A.R.S., Tuticorin—as we shall see below, the choice of bankers too was a matter of debate, forcing VOC to defend the stance taken by the company.

Another important change was in the company's objectives. As stated earlier, it now promised to train Indians, Ceylonese and other Asians in navigation and maritime activities; to establish institutions to impart maritime knowledge and shipbuilding to Indians, Ceylonese and other Asians; to foster friendship and cooperation among Indians, Ceylonese and other Asians in the field of maritime trade and navigation. The company was making a show of its anti-colonial stand by excluding Europeans. It also wished to establish dockyards to build and repair ships, launches and boats.[42] Impractical though it might have been, the vision and the political content of the company were noteworthy. SSNCo was not merely a business enterprise. It was anchored in politics, aiming to regenerate the national economy. VOC's foresight was remarkable to say the least.

Such was the overall mood that even the registrar of joint-stock companies, who would be least expected to observe such changes, noted 'the advent of a new spirit' of enterprise following the emergence of the Swadeshi movement.[43] 'Many of the newly formed trading companies', he remarked, 'appear to be intended to encourage Indian manufactures and industries and sale of Swadeshi goods'.[44] While commenting that the founding of the Indian Bank was 'the direct outcome of the collapse of the Messrs Arbuthnot & Co.', he especially noted that 'the Swadeshi Steam